# David Sutton

### UX & Product Strategy | Product & Process Optimization | Business Modernization

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## Summary

With over a decade of experience at companies like Apple, Verizon, and Xerox, I help scaling businesses modernize operations, streamline their digital tools, and design offerings aligned with what users actually need. I specialize in turning ambiguity into strategy - whether that means digitizing manual processes, leading product development from scratch, or helping founders align teams around a clear vision.

### I'm available for:

- Full-time or contract product/UX leadership roles
- Fractional consulting (strategy, design, operations)
- Turnaround or modernization projects for businesses preparing to scale, sell, or streamline

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## Who I Help & How

### Small Business Owners + Founders

You run a successful business, but your back-office and digital presence may not reflect your expertise. I can help:

- **Automate your business processes**
  Save time with self-running systems for invoicing, onboarding, scheduling, and reminders.

  > **Example:** Reduced manual data entry by 90% for a local healthcare certification org with a bespoke google-platform MVP for tracking progress and communications.

- **Modernize operations and prepare for growth**
  Replace paper forms and ad-hoc emails with digital tools that scale.

  > **Example:** Built systems for a healthcare startup that cut onboarding time in half and boosted user satisfaction from 52% to 96%. Connecting underserved communities with employment opportunities and healthcare providers with necessary staff during covid.

- **Refresh your brand and digital face**
  Align your public web presence, messaging, bookings and offerings so customers "get it" instantly; building brand loyalty and trust.

### Project Teams + Technical Orgs

If you're building a product or platform and need strategic firepower:

- **Fractional UX/Product leadership**
  Bring me in early to define roadmaps, align cross-functional teams, and embed a design-led culture.
- **Research + Testing**
  Ensure your product is solving the right problem before writing code. I'll handle workshops, testing, and insight synthesis.
- **Design systems and team scaling**
  I create tools and playbooks to help your team move faster, collaborate better, and maintain consistency as you grow.

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## Services + Engagement Models

1. Full-Time Employment (W2)
   UX/Product Lead roles in public interest tech, civic design, education, or high-impact product teams
2. Consulting or Contract Work (1099)
   Retained support or project-based deliverables across UX, workflow automation, operations design
3. Fractional Leadership
   Serve as a part-time head of UX, Product, or Ops to guide strategy, mentor staff, and deliver results

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## Testimonials

> "Dave has a special ability to build communities of designers and help others create cool things. I feel lucky to know someone who creates such amazing resources for the community."
> **Jennifer Kotler**, Senior UX Designer
> Space Telescope Science Institute (Webb, Hubble, TESS, and Kepler missions support)

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> "David formed and operated the group at RIT, and was absolutely instrumental in helping it achieve the success and praise it now sees among students. He's proven to be a great team player, coordinator, and facilitator."
> **Sean Boyle**, Senior Lecturer
> Rochester Institute of Technology

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**>>> Next Page: My Work**

## Selected Projects

### WAE Healthcare Staffing Platform

- **Role**
  - Head of UX & Product
- **Challenge**
  - Rebuild failed MVP and scale up a dev team with no existing design systems, roadmap, or leadership
- **What I Did**
  - Introduced dual-track agile system to streamline iteration
  - Built centralized design system, live documentation hub, and rapid testing pipeline
  - Brought in real clients for hands-on prototyping sessions
- **Results**
  - Scheduling time reduced by 50%
  - User satisfaction scores jumped from 52% to 96%
  - MVP launched successfully, now foundation of company offering

**View full case study -**

### MCC Healthcare Certification Program Tracking MVP (Pro Bono Consult)

- **Role**
  - UX Strategist & Systems Builder
- **Challenge**
  - A nonprofit partner needed to track instructor and student participation using only spreadsheets and disjoined documentation
- **What I Did**
  - Refactored and simplified their existing data workflows, adding automations for weekly reminders and reporting
  - Created a google-platform MVP that tracks attendance, certifications, and communications with instructors
- **Results**
  - Reduced manual data cleanup by 80%
  - Made integrated and scalable resource usable by non-technical instructors and admin staff
  - Became a replicable model for other local initiatives and cohorts

### MSM Attention-Grabbing Tech Installations for Client Conversions (Experiential Product Design)

- **Role**
  - UX Consultant, Experience and Games Design
- **Challenge**
  - Create interactive, tech-enhanced exhibits for marketing and trade events
- **What I Did**
  - Designed workflows combining touch screens, NFC, IoT, and gamified data collection
  - Balanced entertainment with lead gen and brand goals
- **Results**
  - Drove 4x higher engagement than prior booth setups
  - Nominated for award in Exhibitor Magazine

**View full case study -**

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## Core Capabilities

- Digital process modernization & workflow optimization
- AI-enhanced systems (automated emails, client intake, reminders)
- UX research, usability testing, service blueprints
- Fractional leadership & team mentoring, Design Ops, Design Systems
- Cross-team alignment & facilitation, instruction, workshops
- Automation an AI integrated solutions across platforms: Airtable, Notion, Zapier, Make etc.

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## Education & Background

**B.S.Human Centered Computing and Information Technology**

Rochester Institute of Technology

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## Let's Talk

If you're not sure what to build, how to scale, or where to begin - I can help. Whether it's auditing what's broken or mapping where to go, I work quickly and collaboratively to create systems that scale and products that make sense.

**Contact:** davidsutton585@gmail.com
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View more of my work on my online portfolio at www.sutton.cx

**>>> Next Page: Full Technical Resume**

# David Sutton

Senior UX/Product Design | AI-Driven UX Strategy

**Email Portfolio LinkedIn**


## Professional Summary

Senior UX/Product Designer and DesignOps Leader with deep experience and passion in AI-enhanced workflows, scalable UX systems, and strategic collaboration across product, engineering, and research. Delivered measurable results for Apple, Xerox, Verizon, and PepsiCo, including accelerating design iteration cycles and significant 44% user satisfaction increases. Combines hands-on execution with player-coach leadership to guide cross-functional teams, mentor junior designers, and integrate AI tools across documentation, decision-making, and sprint planning. Experienced in privacy-sensitive UX environments, including HIPAA-adjacent systems in healthcare and enterprise communication.

## Relevant Skills & Competencies

- AI-Enhanced UX Workflows & Product Design
- UX Research & Rapid Iterative Prototyping
- Cross-Functional Facilitation & DesignOps
- Scalable Component Libraries & Systems Design
- Accessibility & Privacy-Compliant UX
- Agile & Lean UX Frameworks
- Tools: Figma, Miro, Notion, Asana, Slack, Google Workspace

## Professional Experience

### Senior UX Researcher & DesignOps Specialist — WAE | 2021 – 2023

- Led end-to-end UX strategy for a healthcare staffing platform, boosting satisfaction from 52% to 96% through iterative testing and data-driven design strategy.
- Implemented a DesignOps system with scalable documentation and design libraries, reducing design iteration cycles by 50%.
- Created and maintained AI-enhanced UX documentation and workshop materials to support asynchronous product development and stakeholder communication.
- Facilitated cross-functional design sprints and usability testing with real agency clients and healthcare workers; aligning business, engineering, and user experience needs.

### Systems Design & SMB Development Consultant — Verizon and Others | 2018 – Present

- Designed and implemented AI-assisted UX workflows, product audits, and documentation systems to modernize SMB operations and product strategy.
- Advised development teams on team scaling, onboarding flows, and workflow automation using AI-enhanced research and playbooks.
- Improved Salesforce CRM adoption and performance through gamification and training initiatives, increasing engagement and revenue across B2B sales teams.
- Consulted on process optimization and platform design for logistics, retail, and SaaS clients, aligning UX efforts with core business outcomes.

### UX & UI Design Engineer — Xerox | 2015 – 2017

- Introduced rapid prototyping and iterative testing to legacy workflows, reducing research iteration cycles by over 50%.
- Designed mobile-first interfaces and modular design systems for enterprise software, improving usability and reducing onboarding time.
- Conducted UX workshops to align stakeholders, developers, and legal/compliance teams in HIPAA-sensitive communication tools (fax and secure messaging).

### Lead UI/UX & Systems Engineer — Apple | 07/2013 – 07/2014

- Developed responsive UI frameworks supporting Apple's digital platforms, improving scalability and design consistency across devices.
- Conducted user research and usability testing to inform interface design and feature development in high-performance team environments.

## AI Systems Integration & Strategic Automation

- Built internal documentation systems, playbooks, and design guidelines using AI tooling (e.g. custom GPT-based systems) to support async design ops, product audits, and sprint planning.
- Created tailored AI workflows for SMBs and startups, including documentation workflow automation, backlog generation, team onboarding frameworks, discussion summaries and decision-tracking systems.
- Developed reusable, scalable templates for UX research, product definition, and team ceremonies, accelerating product velocity and improving cross-functional transparency.
- Provided consultative support to design and product teams adopting AI tooling, helping align experimentation with business outcomes and responsible design practices.

## Education & Certifications

- Bachelor of Science, Human-Centered Design & Information Technology – Rochester Institute of Technology
- IDEO Human-Centered Design Certification
- LUMA Institute Certifications – Practitioner, Facilitator, and Instructor Levels